

The Stake of the Founder

We've analysed founder stakes across different stages of company growth, from those that have yet to secure equity funding to those that have raised £100m+.

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And so, the further along a company's growth journey, the more diluted a founder's equity stake typically is. Whilst the influx of capital helps to accelerate startups' growth, this process also reduces founder control.



The Stake of the Founder

Analysing founder stakes across different stages of company growth

Beauhurst

In this free report, you'll discover trends in the average founder stakes by:

Company stage and lifecycle

Number of equity funding rounds secured

Value of equity investments secured

Gender of founding teams

Here's a sneak-peak inside

Founders of venture-stage businesses have the smallest stakes

Overall, the stake of high-growth UK founders is greatest at the seed and established stages. For seed startups, whose funding typically stems from grants, angels and the crowd,

FOUNDER STAKES BY CURRENT STAGE OF EVOLUTION

Female founders Male founders All founders

60%

Average founder stakes remain above 25% until the fifth funding round

Despite fluctuations towards the later equity rounds (due to a relatively small sample size), the relationship between equity investment and founder stakes is clear: as companies secure

FOUNDER STAKES BY NUMBER OF FUNDING ROUNDS SECURED

Female founders Male founders All founders

80%

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